

WHISTLEBLOWING POLICY – SIMTEC CONSULT



Document owner: Joseph O'Sullivan, Managing Director

Version: 1.0

Effective date: 26 August 2026

Next review date: 26 August 2027

Approval status: Approved

Simtec Consult Limited encourages workers to speak up about suspected wrongdoing. Genuine concerns will be taken seriously, considered fairly and handled as confidentially as practicable. No one should suffer retaliation for making a protected disclosure or raising a genuine concern in good faith.

1. SCOPE

This policy applies to employees, officers, consultants, contractors, subcontractors, agency workers, casual workers and others working for or with Simtec. It is intended for concerns in the public interest and is not normally the correct route for a personal employment grievance unless the matter also involves wider wrongdoing.

2. WHAT MAY BE REPORTED

A concern may relate to:

- a criminal offence, fraud, bribery, corruption or facilitation of tax evasion;
- a failure to comply with a legal or regulatory obligation;
- a danger to health and safety;
- environmental damage;
- modern slavery, exploitation, discrimination or serious human-rights concerns;
- a miscarriage of justice;
- concealment of any of the above, or retaliation against someone who has raised a concern.

3. HOW TO RAISE A CONCERN

Raise the concern as soon as reasonably practicable with Joseph O'Sullivan, Managing Director, verbally or in writing. Explain the background, relevant dates, people involved and why you are concerned. You do not need to prove the allegation, but you should provide information you reasonably believe to be true.

If the concern involves the Managing Director, or you reasonably believe it would be inappropriate to report it to him, raise it with Simtec's external legal adviser using the contact details issued separately. You may also seek confidential independent advice from Protect or refer to GOV.UK guidance on prescribed persons.

4. CONFIDENTIALITY AND ANONYMITY

Simtec will protect a reporter's identity so far as reasonably practicable and lawful. Information will be shared only where necessary to assess or investigate the concern, take action or comply with law. Anonymous concerns will be considered, although anonymity may limit investigation and feedback.

5. ASSESSMENT AND INVESTIGATION

The recipient will acknowledge the concern where possible, assess any immediate risk, decide whether an investigation or referral is needed and appoint an appropriate person who is not implicated. The scope and timescale will depend on the seriousness and complexity of the matter.

The reporter may be asked for further information and will be given appropriate feedback, subject to confidentiality and legal restrictions.

6. PROTECTION AND SUPPORT

Simtec will not tolerate dismissal, detrimental treatment, threats or victimisation because a person raised a genuine concern or made a protected disclosure. Any retaliation should be reported immediately. A person who deliberately makes a false allegation or acts maliciously may be subject to disciplinary or contractual action; an unsubstantiated concern raised honestly will not result in action against the reporter.

7. EXTERNAL DISCLOSURES

Workers may have legal protection when making disclosures to an appropriate prescribed person or body. The correct body depends on the subject matter. Workers are encouraged to obtain independent advice before making an external disclosure. Nothing in this policy prevents a lawful report to the police, a regulator or another prescribed person.

8. RECORDS AND REVIEW

Reports, decisions, investigations and outcomes will be recorded securely with access restricted to those who need it. Personal information will be retained only as long as necessary. The Managing Director will review this policy and any themes arising from reports at least annually.

APPROVAL

Approved by: Joseph O'Sullivan, Managing Director

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to be 'J. O'Sullivan', with a large loop at the start and several horizontal strokes at the end.

Signature:

Date: 26 August 2026